AI PRODUCT BUILDER · 90-MINUTE BUILD

Maple Freight: What Needs Me Today?

You'll work alone, with any AI tools you normally use. We want to see how you think, build and check your work when the data is messy and the request isn't quite right.

The situation

Maple Freight is a fictional trucking company with **60 vehicles across three depots**: North Yard, Airport Hub and Hamilton Depot. You have **14 days of alerts** from their vehicle telematics devices (September 8–21, 2026), plus a vehicle list, a fault-code reference, the shop's work orders and the telematics vendor's account notes.

It's **Monday, September 21, at 6:00 p.m. Eastern**, and the export was just taken. The operations manager will open what you build tonight, and again before the 6:00 a.m. dispatch tomorrow.

What the team told us

> SAFETY MANAGER
> "We get 150+ alerts a day. My team ignores most of them. I need an AI that ranks every alert high, medium or low. And D-17 is clearly our worst driver. He tops the list every week."

> MAINTENANCE LEAD
> "We only look at engine faults the vendor marks HIGH. Everything else is noise. And V-137's overheating was a bad sensor. The shop fixed it this morning."

> OPERATIONS MANAGER
> "My team can realistically act on about 10 things a day."

YOUR JOB

Work out what actually needs Maple Freight's attention, and build the smallest useful thing that helps them act on it. You decide what to build and who it's for. You'll have to make assumptions, so write them down. If the data supports you, you're free to disagree with anything the team or the vendor told you.

What you hand in

DELIVERABLE	WHAT WE NEED
1 · A working build	Something a person at Maple Freight could actually use: a web page, dashboard, script, notebook or command-line tool. Any language or framework. It must run from your repository with the commands in your README. No hosting needed.
2 · Your top 3 for tonight	In your README: the three things Maple Freight should act on first, each with why it matters, the evidence from the data, and the next action.
3 · Your README	Use README_TEMPLATE.md. Fill in every section, including assumptions, what you chose not to do, and how you checked your work.
4 · Your AI session	A link to, or an export of, your session from whatever AI tool you used.

The files

FILE	WHAT'S IN IT
`alerts.csv`	alert_id, vehicle_id, driver_id, alert_type, vendor_severity, event_time_utc, received_time_utc, value, unit, posted_limit_kmh, dtc_code
`vehicles.csv`	vehicle_id, depot, vehicle_class, device_firmware, assigned_driver, km_driven_14d
`dtc_reference.csv`	Six diagnostic trouble codes, each with its plain meaning and reference urgency
`work_orders.csv`	wo_id, vehicle_id, opened_local, closed_local, status, work_done, technician_note (Maple Freight's shop system; times are Eastern)
`vendor_notes.md`	Notes about the export and devices, copied from the telematics vendor's support portal
`README_TEMPLATE.md`	Copy it into your repository as README.md and fill it in

Alert types: harsh_braking, harsh_accel and harsh_cornering (value in g), speeding (km/h, with the posted limit when known), idling (minutes), engine_fault (with a DTC code), device_unplugged, camera_offline, and maintenance_due (value = km overdue; a negative number means not yet due). event_time_utc is when it happened; received_time_utc is when Maple Freight's system received it. Timestamps are in UTC. Maple Freight works in Eastern time.

Timeline

TIME	MINUTE	WHAT HAPPENS
1:10 p.m.	0	Start. Explore the data.
1:30 p.m.	20	Fill in the **Intent Card** form: four short answers (link on the start page). It takes about five minutes.
2:30 p.m.	80	Start wrapping up: README and submission.
2:40 p.m.	90	Hard stop. The Final Submission form closes at 2:41.

How to submit by 2:40 p.m.

- Push your work to a **GitHub repository**. Make it public, or keep it private and add the GitHub user **`adityasharmazenduit`** as a collaborator. Commit as you go; we look at the history.
- Fill in the **Final Submission form** (link on the start page). If the form fails, email your repository link to adityasharma@zenduit.com.

Rules

- Work on your own. Ask the facilitator, not other candidates. Any clarification we give goes to the whole room.
- Use the AI tools, editors and open-source libraries you normally use. You're responsible for the result and must be able to explain and change it.
- Use only the data we gave you. General public knowledge (for example, what a fault code means) is fine.
- Using AI is never penalized. Misrepresenting what you did versus what the AI did is.

Questions you might have

QUESTION	ANSWER
What exactly should I build?	That's your call, and part of what we're assessing. Pick a user at Maple Freight, decide what they need tonight, and build the smallest thing that gets it to them.
Does the product itself need to use AI?	Your choice. Explain the decision in your README.
Something in the data looks odd. Should I ask?	No. Treat it like a real customer export: decide how to handle it and write your decision under “Assumptions I made”.
Can I talk to the Maple Freight team?	No. The quotes above are everything they said.
How big should it be?	Small and finished beats big and broken. We don't score visual polish.
Do I need API keys or a paid tool?	We don't supply any. Use your own tools. If your build calls a paid API, make sure we can still see it work (for example, include sample output).
Anything else?	Use your judgment and write down your assumption. We'll only answer questions about logistics and rules.

How you'll be scored

Six areas, 100 points in total. We score what we can see in your repository, README, commit history, AI session and Intent Card.

AREA	POINTS	IN ONE LINE
Problem judgment	20	Did you choose what matters, and explain why?
Data diagnosis and working build	25	Did you find what's really in the data, and build something that runs?
AI leverage and verification	20	Did AI make you faster without replacing your judgment?
Product and customer thinking	15	Would it help Maple Freight act on the right things?
Systems and data reasoning	10	Did you reason about data quality, time and what could fail?
Adaptability	10	Can you adjust your plan when things change?

Doesn't affect your score: visual polish, which tools you use, lines of code, or using AI. Misrepresenting what you did versus what the AI did is the only thing that counts against you.

Four candidates will be invited to give a short demo later this afternoon.